

JAZZ PIANO TOOLKIT

A Simple Framework for Jazz Blues Comping



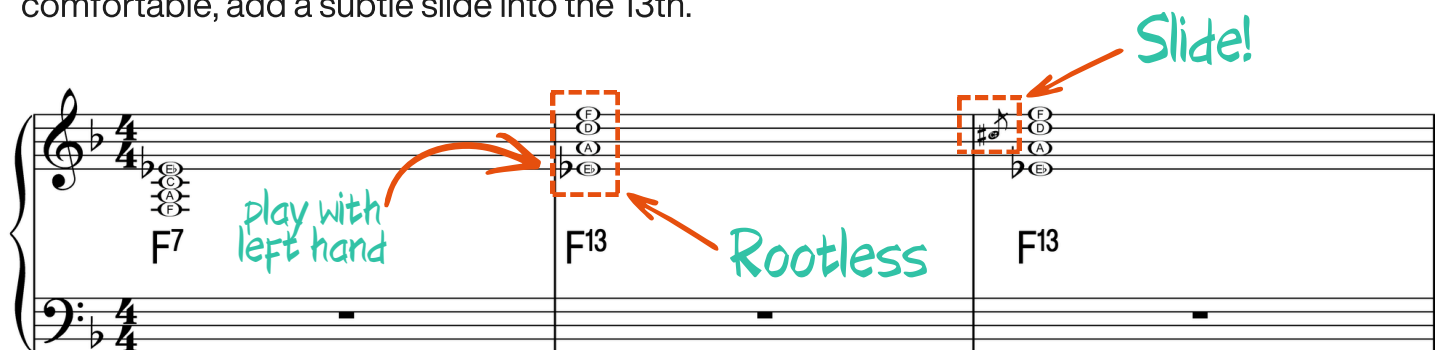
Introduction from Adam

This simple framework is my go-to when I want to play a jazz blues with confidence and a great feel. It's easy to pick up, sounds instantly authentic, and helps you lock into a real swing groove fast.

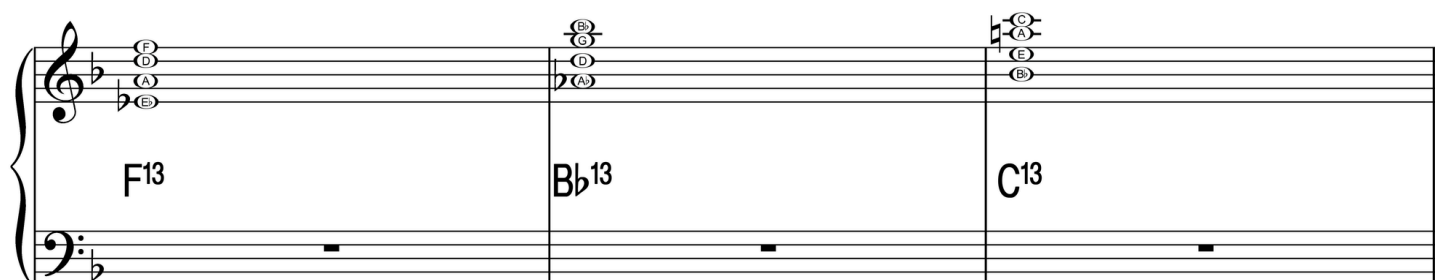
Step #1

Finding the Shapes video 3:50

Start with a rootless F7 voicing built from the **7th, 3rd, and 13th, with the root on top**. This gives you a rich, authentic jazz sound without clashing with the bass. Once the shape feels comfortable, add a subtle slide into the 13th.



Take that same shape and move it to **Bb7** and **C7**. Focus on how little your hand actually needs to move — it should feel smooth and economical.



Step #2

Charleston Rhythm



video 7:40

Play your voicings using the Charleston rhythm. Say it in your head as you play — it helps lock in the groove and gives your comping a natural swing.



"This rhythm comes from the Charleston dance — that's where it gets its swing and bounce!"

Backing Track

Practise this exercise, and all the exercises in this PDF, along with the backing track — the same one Adam uses in the video.



[Click here to access it.](#)

Step #3

Batman Rhythm



video 9:50

Switch to a straight, on-the-beat rhythm with **two hits per bar**. This contrast gives your playing a more grounded, driving feel.

Alternate between Charleston and Batman patterns.

This creates variation and keeps your comping sounding fresh and musical.

Charleston! Batman!

F13 F13 F13 F13

Bb13 Bb13 F13 F13

C13 Bb13 F13 F13

Step #4

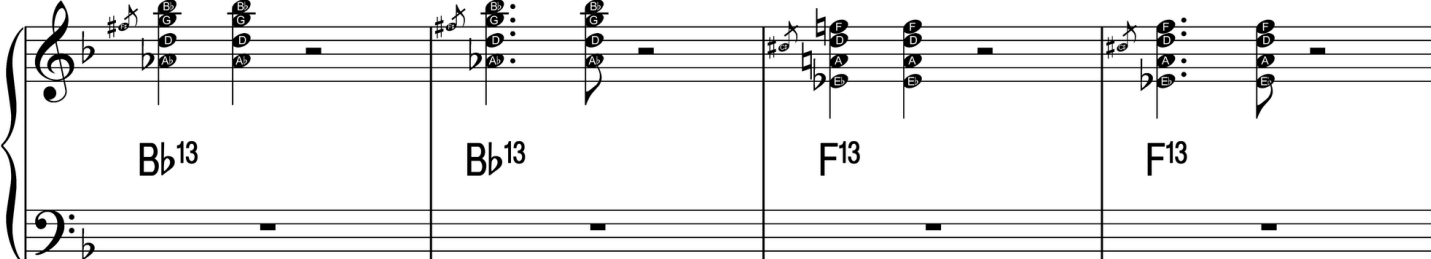
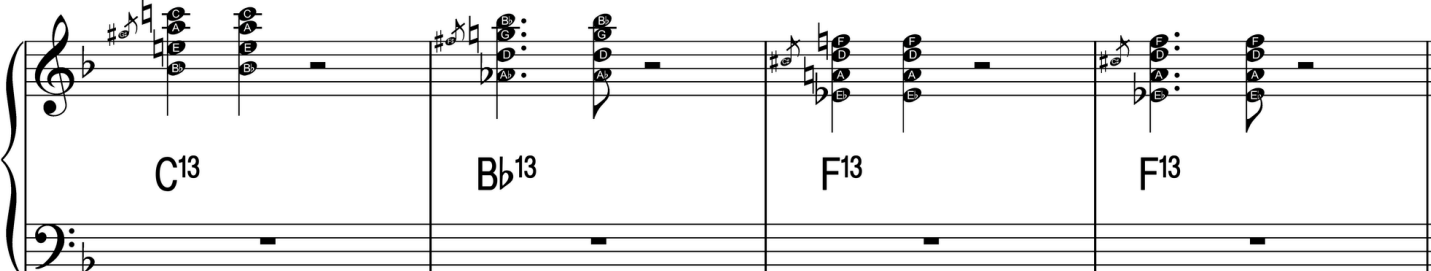
Reversing the Pattern

 video 10:42

Flip the order — try Batman first, then Charleston.

Small changes like this make a big difference to the overall feel.

Batman! Charleston!


"It might feel like a lot to juggle at first, but stick with it — your hands will catch up!"

Step #5

Interjecting Fills (Charleston)



video 12:00

Start by adding a short blues fill in the space after each

Charleston hit.

Keep it simple — just a few notes — and aim to land cleanly back on the next chord.



"This is a rough approximation of what I'm playing at the end of the video!"



Staff 1: Four measures of music. Each measure starts with a **F13** chord in the left hand and a short blues fill in the right hand. The fills consist of eighth and sixteenth notes. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

Staff 2: Four measures of music. The first two measures start with a **Bb13** chord, and the last two start with an **F13** chord. Each measure includes a short blues fill in the right hand. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

Staff 3: Four measures of music. The first two measures start with a **C13** chord, and the last two start with an **F13** chord. Each measure includes a short blues fill in the right hand. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

 video 12:32

Drop in quick, punchy fills between each pair of chords, making sure they stay rhythmically tight and don't rush the groove.



“This is a rough approximation of what I’m playing at the end of the video!”

The piano accompaniment is written for the right hand on a single staff. It consists of four measures. The first measure contains a B-flat major triad (B-flat, D, F) with a 13th extension (A-flat), labeled Bb13. The second measure contains a B-flat major triad (B-flat, D, F) with a 13th extension (A-flat), labeled Bb13. The third measure contains an F major triad (F, A, C) with a 13th extension (E-flat), labeled F13. The fourth measure contains an F major triad (F, A, C) with a 13th extension (E-flat), labeled F13. The notation includes various accidentals and note values to create a rhythmic accompaniment.

Musical score for the piano introduction of "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The score is in G major, 4/4 time, and features a piano (p) dynamic. The first measure is a whole note chord of C major (C4, E4, G4). The second measure is a whole note chord of Bb major (Bb3, D4, F4). The third measure is a whole note chord of F major (F3, A3, C4). The fourth measure is a whole note chord of F major (F3, A3, C4). The bass line is mostly silent, with a few notes in the fourth measure.